



LIONS LIGHT ACADEMY

Teacher & Volunteer Expectations

Authority, Clarity, and Support

*"It is the glory of God to conceal a matter, but the glory of kings is to
search it out."*

PROVERBS 25:2

EFFECTIVE

September 15, 2026

DOCUMENT

Version 2.0

This version supersedes Version 1.0 and replaces the separate Training & Acknowledgment document, which is now folded in at the end. Works alongside: Code of Conduct v1.2 · Escalation & Discipline Policy v1.2 · Teacher & Mentor Guidebook v2.0 · Supervision & Room Operations SOP v1.1 · Student Safety & Emergency Plan v1.3

Purpose & Role

Teachers and volunteers at Lions Light Academy keep this place safe, orderly, and Christ-centered. Without you there is no co-op.

This document says what you are responsible for, what you are authorized to do without asking, and what belongs to leadership instead. It exists so you can act with confidence rather than wondering whether you're allowed to.

Role Clarity

Teachers

- Instruction and lesson leadership
- Classroom management
- Maintaining order and safety
- Holding LLA expectations consistently
- Deciding when behavior is costing the class its instruction

Room Leads — assigned to larger or higher-movement spaces

- Supporting transitions and flow between spaces
- Assisting with supervision during movement
- Helping keep order in common areas
- Making sure students know where to go next
- Not overriding a teacher's decisions in their room

Volunteers and Parent Helpers

- Assisting with supervision

- Supporting transitions and activities
- Reinforcing teacher direction
- Bringing concerns to the teacher or to leadership rather than settling them alone

Volunteers do not override teacher authority. In an instructional space, the teacher is the final authority unless leadership steps in.

Authority & Boundaries

You are authorized to act. Do not wait for permission.

Every teacher and supervising adult may correct behavior immediately, set boundaries, hold classroom expectations, and remove a student from an activity or class temporarily when the room needs it.

You do not need to find leadership first. You do not need to check whether it's your place. Handle what is in front of you, then tell us what happened.

Hesitating to correct is not gentleness. A room where students are unsure whether the adult will act is an anxious room, and anxious students do not learn well.

What is not yours to decide. You report; leadership issues warnings, notifies families, defines repair, and determines restoration or removal. That division protects you as much as it protects the student — you are never the person who ended a child's enrollment.

Where a student disputes what happened, that is not yours to settle either. Report your account. Leadership hears the student and the family alongside you and makes a written finding before anyone is asked to take ownership of anything.

Correction, in Practice

Our Escalation & Discipline Policy sorts behavior into three levels. In the room:

Minor — a disruption, slow to follow instructions, a sharp tone, a device out when it shouldn't be. Correct it on the spot and keep going. Minor concerns are not counted or tracked.

Moderate — it keeps happening after correction, or there's disrespect toward an adult or a peer, or required work wasn't done for two sessions running, or a student simply will not engage. Pull them aside, or out of the activity if you need to. Report it to leadership, who issue the warning and notify the family.

Severe — anything unsafe, aggressive, or threatening, or defiance that puts the room at risk. Remove immediately, get leadership, parents are called that day. No warning at this level — one severe incident begins the Reconciliation Process.

Severity determines the response. A severe incident never waits behind a warning count, and repeated minor concerns never become severe by adding up — you may raise a pattern to Moderate, and no further.

The warning limit. The first and second Moderate concerns in a school year each carry a documented warning. A third begins the Reconciliation Process. Warnings count across the whole co-op rather than per class, and they reset each year. You are not expected to track this — leadership confirms the current count before any warning is finalized, so you will never trigger the Reconciliation Process without being told that's what you're doing.

When a student is restored, their count returns to zero. Treat them accordingly. Carrying it forward in how you speak to them undoes the entire point.

Assignment Preparedness

Teachers may require work to be completed before co-op instruction. A lesson built on reading nobody did stalls for everyone in the room.

The line is two sessions. Required work not completed for two class sessions in a row is a Moderate concern, and you raise it. You do not need a month of evidence and you do not need permission first.

Before the warning is finalized, leadership checks that there isn't an unmet support or accommodation need underneath it. That is a check, not a veto — if there's no support need, your call stands exactly as you made it, and you'll be told either way.

Stepping a Student Out to Finish Work

A student who arrives without the work the lesson depends on, or falls behind partway through, may be sent to finish it in the hallway or lounge and rejoin when it's done.

This is not discipline. Nothing is recorded and it counts toward nothing. It protects the lesson for the students who came ready.

Supervision, always. The adult in the main room supervises the hallway. A student uses the teachers lounge only when an adult is already in it — if the lounge is empty, no student goes there. Never send a

student anywhere no adult can see them.

Judgment About a Student's Circumstances

Kids go through things. When you can see something real is going on with a student, use your judgment and extend some room. You know them, which is why you're teaching them.

Two boundaries on that.

It is your judgment, not their argument. A student who opens with "I've had a hard week" every week is showing you the problem rather than giving you a reason.

Grace adjusts how you come at it, not what you expect. The work still has to get done.

Where a student genuinely can't rather than won't, and it's more than you can absorb in your class, bring it to leadership. Don't carry it alone and don't let it quietly turn into a discipline matter.

Holding a Standard

We expect students to be pushed. Not harshly, and never by comparison to each other, but toward what they're actually capable of.

- Expect more than the minimum
- Ask for the revision
- Let them struggle before you rescue them
- Praise effort and growth, not only results
- Hold the standard warmly, and hold it every time

A standard that moves with your mood teaches students to read you instead of reaching. The Teacher & Mentor Guidebook covers this at length in Section 5.

Supervision Expectations

- Actively supervise at all times — presence in the room is not supervision
- Stay aware during instruction and during transitions

- Students remain in assigned, supervised areas, except when stepped out to finish work as described above
 - Follow the ratios in the Student Safety & Emergency Plan and the day procedures in the Supervision & Room Operations SOP
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Classroom Management

- Begin prepared and on time
- State expectations clearly at the start
- Address disruptions promptly and calmly
- Protect instructional time, including by holding the preparedness standard

A structured room and a gracious one are the same room.

Safety & Emergency Responsibilities

Read the Student Safety & Emergency Plan before you serve. The procedures live there and are not repeated here, so there is only ever one safety document to keep current.

What is expected of you in the moment:

- Follow the Incident Lead's direction — that is Damian or Ginny
 - Send for Damian or Ginny immediately for anything medical, and stay with the student
 - Assist with student accountability when directed
 - Stay calm and steady. Students take their cue from you
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Background Checks

Every adult in a teaching or volunteer role completes a background check before serving, renewed every two years.

This is not negotiable and it is not personal. It is the baseline any parent is entitled to expect from a program that supervises their children.

Communication & Escalation

- Communicate concerns clearly and professionally
 - Report promptly rather than letting a pattern build quietly
 - Act on what's in front of you, then escalate — those are not in tension
 - Raise significant discipline matters to leadership rather than resolving them alone
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Professional Conduct

- Model respectful, faith-based behavior
 - Use appropriate language
 - Maintain appropriate boundaries with students
 - Support leadership decisions publicly, and raise disagreements privately through proper channels
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Orientation

Every teacher and volunteer completes a basic orientation before serving. It is meant to be clarifying, not burdensome.

Orientation covers your role and authority, the escalation pathway, emergency roles, and time for questions. It may be delivered in person, in a small group, or through written materials and discussion.

Clarifications may come verbally or in writing as the year goes on. We prefer ongoing conversation over formal retraining.

Continued Participation

LLA may require acknowledgment before continued participation, provide additional guidance where needed, and limit or discontinue participation where expectations are not upheld. Such decisions are made carefully and in alignment with the mission and values of Lions Light Academy.

Acknowledgment

By signing, I confirm that I have:

- Reviewed this document, the Code of Conduct, and the Escalation & Discipline Policy
- Read the Teacher & Mentor Guidebook, if I am teaching
- Understood my role and my authority
- Agreed to operate within these expectations
- Agreed to report concerns rather than resolve significant discipline matters alone
- Completed, or will complete before serving, a background check

Name: _____

Role — teacher, co-teacher, volunteer, admin: _____

Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

Background check completed on: _____